

What the System Remembers: The Bridge Forward

系统记住了什么：通向下一程

Theme: 科学、技术与互联网 · New: 45 · Review: 18 · Planned cumulative progress: 45/6, 127

English Story

The seventh arc closed with a **scheme** that fitted into a **bucket**. **Ten** fields, a **pause** on the launch, and a **capacity** of one page: the **implementation** of the new form was so small that the **director** laughed. “A **scientist** would call this a **minor result**,” he said. “A **physicist** would call it a clean one.”

The **route** to the review was **even** shorter than they expected. A **mistake** in the old **category** list, a **loss** of two weeks, and an **enormous inquiry** from the **national** office: none of it changed the **output**. “**Specify** the **minimum**, **assign** the **maximum**, and **fill** the rest with nothing,” Maya said.

The **housing** of the servers, the **continuous** hum of the **virtual** machines, and the **aged lorry** that brought the new equipment: the physical part of the system had a **duration** of about **ten** years. “**Put** the **restriction** in the code, not in the contract,” the engineer said. “**Compatibility** is a promise we can keep.”

The **contamination** of one dataset by another was a small **bomb** in the middle of the file. “We can **undo** this,” the analyst said. “We cannot **undo** a person's **loss** of trust with a query.” The **quantity** of **champagne** ordered for the launch was, in the **end**, a **minus** rather than a **plus**.

The group came back to the same question: **who** is the system for? The **wait** at the entrance, the **level** of detail on the form, and the **clear view** of the exit were the whole answer. “**If** it includes us, it will **include** the person after us,” Lin said, and followed the last line of the report to its **end**.

The **inquiry** would continue, the **national** list would grow, and the next period would begin with a smaller system than the one they had pulled apart. That was the **result** they could **put** in front of the board — and the one they could defend. The **difference** between a **scheme** and a **mistake** is the **loss** it can absorb; the **route** to the review, the **category** of the **output**, and the **housing** of the servers all had to **fit** inside a **capacity** of one page. The **national inquiry** would **expand**, the **restriction** would be specified, and **our continuous coverage** would be measured in weeks. A **quota** every week, an **upright** posture at the desk, and a **frequency** of **ten** checks a month would **imply** a smaller and cleaner system, and nothing here would **kill** the project. The **start** of the next period would be smaller, and that was the point of the whole exercise. The system remembered less and the trust grew; that was the only exchange rate that ever worked.

中文翻译

第七段弧线以一个能装进一只桶的方案收尾。十个字段、发布的一次暂停，以及一页纸的容量：新表格的实施如此之小，连主管都笑了。“科学家会把这叫做一个次要的结果，”他说，“物理学家会把它叫做一个干净的结果。”

通往复审的路线比他们预想的更短。旧类别清单里的一个错误、两周的损失，以及国家办公室一份庞大的质询：这些都没有改变产出。“规定最小值、指派最大值，其余的用空来填，”曼雅说。

服务器的外壳、虚拟机持续不断的嗡鸣，以及运来新设备的旧卡车：系统物理部分的持续时间大约十年。“把限制写进代码，而不是写进合同，”工程师说，“兼容性是一个我们能守住的承诺。”

一份数据集被另一份污染，是文件中央的一枚小炸弹。“这个我们可以撤销，”分析师说，“但我们无法用一次查询撤销一个人失去的信任。”为发布订购的香槟数量，说到底是一个减号，而不是加号。

小组回到同一个问题：这个系统是谁做的？入口处的等待、表格上细节的层级，以及出口那一目了然的视野，就是全部的答案。“如果它包含我们，它也会包含我们之后的那个人，”林伟说，并一路跟着报告的最后一行读到了结尾。

质询会继续，全国清单会变长，而下一个周期会从一个比他们拆开的那个更小的系统开始。这就是他们能摆到董事会面前的结果——也是他们能为之辩护的那一个。一个方案与一个错误之间的差别，在于它能吸收多大的损失；通往复审的路径、产出的类别，以及服务器的外壳，都必须装进一页纸的容量里。全国质询会扩大，限制会被明确写出，而我们的持续覆盖将以周为单位计量。每周一个配额、在桌前挺直的姿态，以及每月十次检查的频率：这些意味着一套更小、更干净的系统，而这里没有任何一样会杀死这个项目。下一个周期的开始会更小，而这正是整件事的意义所在。

Core Vocabulary · 核心词汇

Word / Pronunciation	Context meaning / source example
even 'i:vən POS: a	a. 平坦的, 相等的, 连贯的, 均等的, 公平的, 偶数的, 平均的, 平衡的, 恰好的; vt. 使平坦, 使相等; vi. 变平, 成... Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. become even or more even; v. make even or more even; a. divisible by two; s. equal in degree or extent or amo...
ten ten POS: num	num. 十, 十个 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the cardinal number that is the sum of nine and one; the base of the decimal system; s. being one more than...
director di'rektə POS: n	n. 主管, 导演, 董事; [计] 寻向偶极子; 指挥仪 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. someone who controls resources and expenditures; n. member of a board of directors; n. someone who supervise...
scheme ski:m POS: n	n. 方案, 计划, 组合, 系统, 图解, 诡计, 阴谋; v. 计划, 设计, 图谋, 策划 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. an elaborate and systematic plan of action; v. form intrigues (for) in an underhand manner; v. devise a syst...
loss lɒs POS: n	n. 损失, 遗失, 失败, 输, 错过, 伤亡; [化] 损失; 损耗 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. something that is lost; n. gradual decline in amount or activity; n. the act of losing someone or something; ...
fill fil POS: vt	vt. 装满, 填充, 弥漫, 供给, 满足, 供应; vi. 充满, 变得沉重; n. 满足, 装满, 充分, 填方; vt. 填充; vi. ... Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a quantity sufficient to satisfy; v. make full, also in a metaphorical sense; v. become full; v. assume, as o...
fit fit POS: n	n. 适宜, 合身, 发作, 痉挛; a. 适宜的, 对的, 准备好的; vt. 适合, 安装, 使合身, 使适应, 使合格; vi. 适合, ... Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a display of bad temper; n. the manner in which something fits; v. be the right size or shape; fit correctly...
scientist 'saɪəntɪst POS: n	n. 科学家; [医] 科学家 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a person with advanced knowledge of one or more sciences
route ru:t POS: n	n. 路径, 途径, 路线; vt. 确定路线, 按规定路线发送; [计] 传递, 路由设定程序 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. send documents or materials to appropriate destinations; v. send via a specific route; v. divert in a specif...
plus plʌs POS: prep	prep. 加上, 加, 外加; a. 正的, 附加的; n. 正号, 加号, 附加额, 正数, 增益; [计] 正差 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. on the positive side or higher end of a scale; s. involving advantage or good
category 'kætigəri POS: n	n. 种类, 类项; [计] 分类 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a general concept that marks divisions or coordinations in a conceptual scheme
mistake mis'teɪk POS: n	n. 错误, 误会; vi. 犯错, 误认; vt. 误解, 弄错; [计] 错误 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a wrong action attributable to bad judgment or ignorance or inattention; n. an understanding of something t...
housing 'haʊsɪŋ POS: n	n. 遮盖, 住房供给, 居留(处), 房屋, 装饰; [化] 外壳 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. structures collectively in which people are housed; n. a protective cover designed to contain or support a...
capacity ke'pæsəti POS: n	n. 容量, 能力, 才能, 资格; [计] 容量 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. capability to perform or produce; n. the amount that can be contained; n. the maximum production possible; n. ...
output 'aʊtput POS: n	n. 输出, 产品, 产量; [计] 输出 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. production of a certain amount; n. the quantity of something (as a commodity) that is created (usually with...
expand ɪk'spænd POS: vt	vt. 使膨胀, 详述, 扩张; vi. 张开, 发展; vt. 展开; vi. 展开; [计] 展开; DOS外部命令:将原始DOS磁盘上的压缩... Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. extend in one or more directions; v. become larger in size or volume or quantity; v. make bigger or wider in...
imply ɪm'plai POS: vt	vt. 暗示, 意味; [计] 隐含 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. express or state indirectly; v. suggest as a logically necessary consequence; in logic; v. have as a necessa...
coverage 'kʌvərɪdʒ POS: n	n. 覆盖的范围, 保险总额, 新闻报导; [化] 可达范围; 覆盖度 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the total amount and type of insurance carried; n. the extent to which something is covered; n. the news as...
minor 'maɪnə POS: n	n. 未成年人, 副修科目; a. 较小的, 二流的, 未成年的; vi. 副修; [计] 次要 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. of lesser importance or stature or rank; a. lesser in scope or effect; a. inferior in number or size or amou...
bomb bɒm POS: n	n. 炸弹; vt. 轰炸, 投弹于; vi. 失败 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. an explosive device fused to explode under specific conditions

Word / Pronunciation	Context meaning / source example
enormous 'ɪnɔ:məs POS: a	a. 巨大的, 庞大的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s. extraordinarily large in size or extent or amount or power or degree; that a whole civilization should be...
inquiry in'kwaɪəri POS: n	n. 质询, 探索, 调查, 询盘; [计] 询问; 查询 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a search for knowledge; n. a systematic investigation of a matter of public interest
quantity 'kwɒntəti POS: n	n. 量, 数量, 总量; [计] 数量; 量 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. an adequate or large amount; n. the concept that something has a magnitude and can be represented in mathem...
restriction ri'strɪkʃən POS: n	n. 限制, 限定, 约束; [计] 限定 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a principle that limits the extent of something; n. the act of keeping something within specified bounds (b...
specify 'spesɪfaɪ POS: vt	vt. 详列, 指定, 说明; [计] 指定 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. decide upon or fix definitely; v. determine the essential quality of; v. be specific about
frequency 'frɪ:kwensi POS: n	n. 频率, 频数; [计] 频率 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the number of occurrences within a given time period; n. the ratio of the number of observations in a stati...
maximum 'mæksɪmən POS: n	n. 极点, 最大量, 极大; a. 最高的, 最大的, 最大极限的; [计] 最大值 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the largest possible quantity; n. the point on a curve where the tangent changes from positive on the left...
pause pəʊz POS: n	n. 暂停, 中止, 停顿, 间歇, 踌躇, 休止符; vi. 暂停, 中止, 停顿, 踌躇; [计] DOS内部命令:暂时停止批处理文件的执行 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a time interval during which there is a temporary cessation of something; n. temporary inactivity; v. cease...
assign ə'saɪn POS: vt	vt. 分配, 指派, 赋值; [计] 赋值 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. give out; v. select something or someone for a specific purpose; v. transfer one's right to; v. decide as to...
minimum 'mɪnɪmə POS: a	a. 最小的, 最低的; n. 最小值; [计] 最小值 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the smallest possible quantity; n. the point on a curve where the tangent changes from negative on the left...
implementation ˌɪmplɪmen'teɪʃən POS: n	n. 安装启用, 实行, 履行; [计] 实施; 实现 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the act of implementing (providing a practical means for accomplishing something); carrying into effect
aged 'eɪdʒɪd POS: a	a. 老的, 陈的, 有...岁的; [化] 老化的; 老化了的; 陈化的; 陈化了的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. people who are old collectively; s. advanced in years; ('aged' is pronounced as two syllables); s. at an adv...
continuous kən'tɪnjuəs POS: a	a. 连续的, 继续的, 连续不断的; [计] 连续的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. continuing in time or space without interruption; a. of a function or curve; extending without break or irr...
lorry 'lɒri POS: n	n. 卡车, 货车; [化] 载重汽车 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a large low horse-drawn wagon without sides; n. a large truck designed to carry heavy loads; usually withou...
champagne ʃæm'peɪn POS: n	n. 香槟酒, 香槟酒色; [化] 香槟酒 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a white sparkling wine either produced in Champagne or resembling that produced there; n. a region of north...
virtual 'vɜ:tʃuəl POS: a	a. 实际上起作用的, 虚的, 实质的, 有效的, 事实上生效的; [计] 虚拟 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s. being actually such in almost every respect; s. existing in essence or effect though not in actual fact
duration dju'reɪʃən POS: n	n. 持续时间, 持续; [计] 持续时间 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the period of time during which something continues; n. the property of enduring or continuing in time; n. c...
bucket 'bʌkɪt POS: n	n. 桶; [计] 存储桶; 桶 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a roughly cylindrical vessel that is open at the top; n. the quantity contained in a bucket; v. put into a b...
quota 'kwɒtə POS: n	n. 配额, 限额; [化] 定额 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a prescribed number; n. a proportional share assigned to each participant; n. a limitation on imports
minus 'maɪnəs POS: n	n. 负号, 不足; a. 减的, 负的, 阴性的; prep. 减, 缺; [计] 负差 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. on the negative side or lower end of a scale; s. involving disadvantage or harm
physicist 'fɪzɪsɪst POS: n	n. 物理学家, 机械唯物论者, 自然科学家; [医] 菲西克氏手术(虹膜圆片切除) Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a scientist trained in physics

Word / Pronunciation	Context meaning / source example
undo ˌʌn'du: POS: vt	vt. 解开, 取消, 破坏, 毁灭, 扰乱; vi. 松开; [计] 撤消 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. cancel, annul, or reverse an action or its effect; v. cause the ruin or downfall of
contamination kən.tæmɪ'neɪʃən POS: n	n. 污染, 污物; [化] 污染; 沾污 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the state of being contaminated; n. the act of contaminating or polluting; including (either intentionally...
upright 'ʌpraɪt POS: a	a. 正直的, 诚实的, 公正的, 垂直的, 竖式的; [化] 立杆 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a vertical structural member as a post or stake; n. a piano with a vertical sounding board; s. in a vertical...
compatibility kəm.pæte'bɪlɪti POS: n	n. 兼容性; [计] 兼容性 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a feeling of sympathetic understanding; n. capability of existing or performing in harmonious or congenial...